

WAYS OF WORKING

How we work together, and where things live

Digital team · 10 September 2026

“You and I are drowning in no structure.
And if we are drowning, what will
our team feel like?”

Erica, earlier this week

FIRST, WHAT THIS IS NOT

Not restructuring 776 work items

Not changing tooling today

Not asking anyone to redo past work

**What it is: four things agreed, so everyone knows where work goes
and what happens when.**

BEFORE WE START

Invisible drag

Everyone nods. Everyone agrees.
The work goes in different directions anyway.

Usually because one word meant different things to different people.
So here are the five that matter today.

WHAT I MEAN BY

Structure

I don't mean

Process for its own sake.
More approvals to get through.

I do mean

Everyone knowing where a thing goes, and who picks it up.

WHAT I MEAN BY

Ceremony

I don't mean

More meetings.

I do mean

Fewer meetings, with a written purpose, that end in something changing on the board.

WHAT I MEAN BY

Feature

I don't mean

Everything you work on.

I do mean

The unit we prioritise and track value against. Your day-to-day sits underneath it, and that's fine.

WHAT I MEAN BY

Ways of working

I don't mean

A standard you get measured against.

I do mean

The small number of agreements that stop us tripping over each other.

WHAT I MEAN BY

The board

I don't mean

It could mean four things —
the tool, what's typed into it,
whether people update it...

I do mean

**...or whether it reflects what's
actually true. I mean that one.
Others may mean a different one.**

01

Teams structure

Where things live, and which door to knock on · 15 min

Three departments

Inform Digital

Internal IT and management escalation

Digital Capability

Everything that supports delivery to clients, but not client delivery

Client Delivery

The engagements. Already exists per client

Two shop windows, because the audiences differ.

02

Ceremonies

Why, when, how often, and what comes out · 15 min

A ceremony that doesn't change the board is a conversation.

Engineering check-in

Daily, short

Unblocks fast

Delivery review

Weekly

Features move, priorities set

Ways of working

Monthly

Where this gets amended

Every one gets a written purpose and an agenda.

03

Backlogs and DevOps

How work is tracked, and how it fits together · 15 min

Product Family › Product › Feature › PBI

Features are what we prioritise and track value against.

PBIs are how the team gets a feature done — that's the team doing their work, and it doesn't need steering from above.

Six changes. Not 776.

Three epics for the three blocks

Resolve the AI strategy duplicates

Own the capability build

Add the missing epics

Collapse legacy behind a label

Decide if Frontier Firm gets an item

04

Ways of working

The small number of agreements · 15 min

“Keep it simple to start with and build on it. Build the basics, iterate from there.”

Erica

On tooling: this is not a decision. It's a decision to stop arguing about tools until we have numbers. DevOps is the floor, not the winner.

WHAT CHANGES TOMORROW

Every recurring meeting gets a purpose and an agenda

Features are what we prioritise; PBIs are how work gets done

If we discuss it, it lands on the board

When we find a gap, the first question is “was this ever anyone's job” — not “who dropped this”

Nothing else changes this week

OVER TO YOU

What's missing, and what's too much?

Nothing here is finished. If there's a better way to get there,
I'd rather have that than my version.